

First Aid

Bites and Stings

Dog bites

Dog bites are a significant public health issue in Egypt, over 1.2 million cases recorded in 2025, leading to approximately 50-60 annual rabies deaths. Worldwide, India has the highest rate of human rabies in the world primarily due to stray dogs. Stray dogs are the primary cause, particularly in densely populated areas like Cairo and Giza. Immediate post-exposure treatment (vaccine/serum) is crucial. Rabies Threat: Around 90% of rabies cases in Egypt are linked to dog bites. Rabies causes about 50-60 human deaths annually, with about 70% of victims not receiving timely preventive treatment

Rabies post-exposure prophylaxis (PEP) is a life-saving, highly effective treatment consisting of immediate wound cleaning, a dose of rabies immunoglobulin (RIG), and a series of rabies vaccines. It must be initiated immediately after exposure (bites or scratches from suspected rabid animals) before symptoms develop to prevent the near-always fatal disease

First aid measures

- 1- Wash immediately the bite area -wound- with soap and water thoroughly.
- 2- Apply pressure if bite is actively bleeding
- 3- Cover the wound with:

- a sterile dressing or
 - clean pad bandaged in place
- 4-Go to the nearest hospital for anti-rabies vaccine and post exposure treatment
- 5-Do not wait: Rabies is nearly 100% fatal once symptoms appear

Snake bites

Snake bite from a venomous snake is a medical emergency requiring immediate, calm action and urgent hospital treatment. Key symptoms include puncture wounds, severe pain, swelling, nausea, or dizziness

First aid measures

1. Calm the casualty & Lay him down.
2. Wash the wound thoroughly with soap and water
3. Cut and apply mouth suck method (if a suction cup is not available).
4. Quickly transport victim to medical center for anti-venom.

Precautions:

DO NOT

Apply mouth suck method if you have any mouth skin break.

Scorpion Sting

Most scorpion stings cause immediate pain, tingling, and numbness, similar to a bee sting, and can be treated at home. While serious reactions are rare—severe symptoms like breathing difficulties or muscle spasm requires emergency.

First aid measures

- 1- Call 123
- 2- Assess: Airway, Breathing & Circulation
- 3- Clean thoroughly site with soap and water or rubbing alcohol
- 4- Quickly transport victim to medical center for anti-venom.

DO

Apply icepack on wound.

Bee stings

Bee stings cause immediate sharp pain, swelling, and itching, usually lasting a few hours to several days, with swelling potentially peaking at 48 hours. For, most, symptoms subside within a few days.

First aid measures

1. Do not panic & slowly walk away from the insect.
2. Immediately scraping out the stinger,
3. Cleaning with soap and water

4. Applying cold packs.
5. Immediately go to the nearest hospital.
6. Check the sting site for the venom sac and stinger.
7. Put on calamine lotion to ease itching
8. Administer anti-inflammatory (aspirin) or antihistamines to alleviate pain and localize reaction.

Jellyfish Sting

Jellyfish are present in the Mediterranean, Red Sea, particularly appearing in blooms during spring (March-May) and late summer (August-October), with higher concentrations near shore due to winds and currents. While most species like the Moon Jellyfish are relatively harmless, some can cause mild to uncomfortable sting. It is found in different colors; colorless, blue, white, purple or brown

First aid measures

- 1-Calm and reassure the victim.
- 2-Seek medical help immediately.
- 3-Cover with sand and carefully pull it off use a heavy gloves or clothes
- 4-Gently wash the injury using sea water
- 5-If possible, pour concentrated vinegar or use hot water immersion to help neutralize venom and ease discomfort

Precautions: DO NOT

Touch jelly fish with your bare hand or skin, use sand, or cards

First Aid and Poisoning

Routes:

- Oral(ingested by mouth)
- Inhaled (respiration)
- Local or contact (absorbed through skin)
- Injected (injected through Intravenous)

Oral(ingested):

This is Given or taken by mouth. It can be in the form of rotten food or drink metals etc

Signs & symptoms

1. Nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain or diarrhea.
2. Abnormal respiration.
3. Unconsciousness.
4. Seizures.

5. Burn around mouth and lips in ingesting corrosive substance

First aid measures

- 1- Check pulse & respiration
- 2- Call 125-140, or poison control center & Give the following information:
 - Who? What? How much? How? When?
 - Is the victim consciousness or unconsciousness?
 - Presence of vomiting or convulsions
- 3- Keep a sample of the victim's vomitus, urine & stool.

Precautions:

DO NOT

1. Do not give water or milk to dilute poisons unless instructed by the physician
2. Do not induce vomiting unless advised by the physician

Contact poisoning

It is what can be direct on the skin

Signs & symptoms

- 1- Decrease blood pressure
- 2- Dyspnea (difficulty in breathing) and slow pulse
- 3- Blurred vision
- 4- Contracted (small in size) pupil
- 5- Convulsion and excessive sweating

First aid measures

- 5- Remove clothing.

6-Flush the affected skin with cool water for several minutes.

7-If the poison has entered eyes; flush them for at least 15 minutes.

8-Go to the nearest hospital emergency room.

Inhaled poisoning

It is poisoning that takes place through respiration

Signs & symptoms

- Headache and
- Chest pain and muscle weakness
- Blurred vision
- Nausea and vomiting
- Pink color of the skin turned to blue color
- Decrease in heart rate and respiratory rate
- Loss of consciousness

First aid measures

1-Turn off the source of gas.

2-Call 123.

3-Open windows to ventilate or go out in open air.

4-Remove the victim from area then check breathing & pulse, if the victim is not breathing start CPR.

5-Place unconscious victim on his side and loosen tight clothing.

Precautions:

1. Always ensures that poisonous substances are kept if necessary.
2. Medications should be locked away from children
3. All substances are labeled and understood before use.
4. All substances and medications should be disposed correctly.